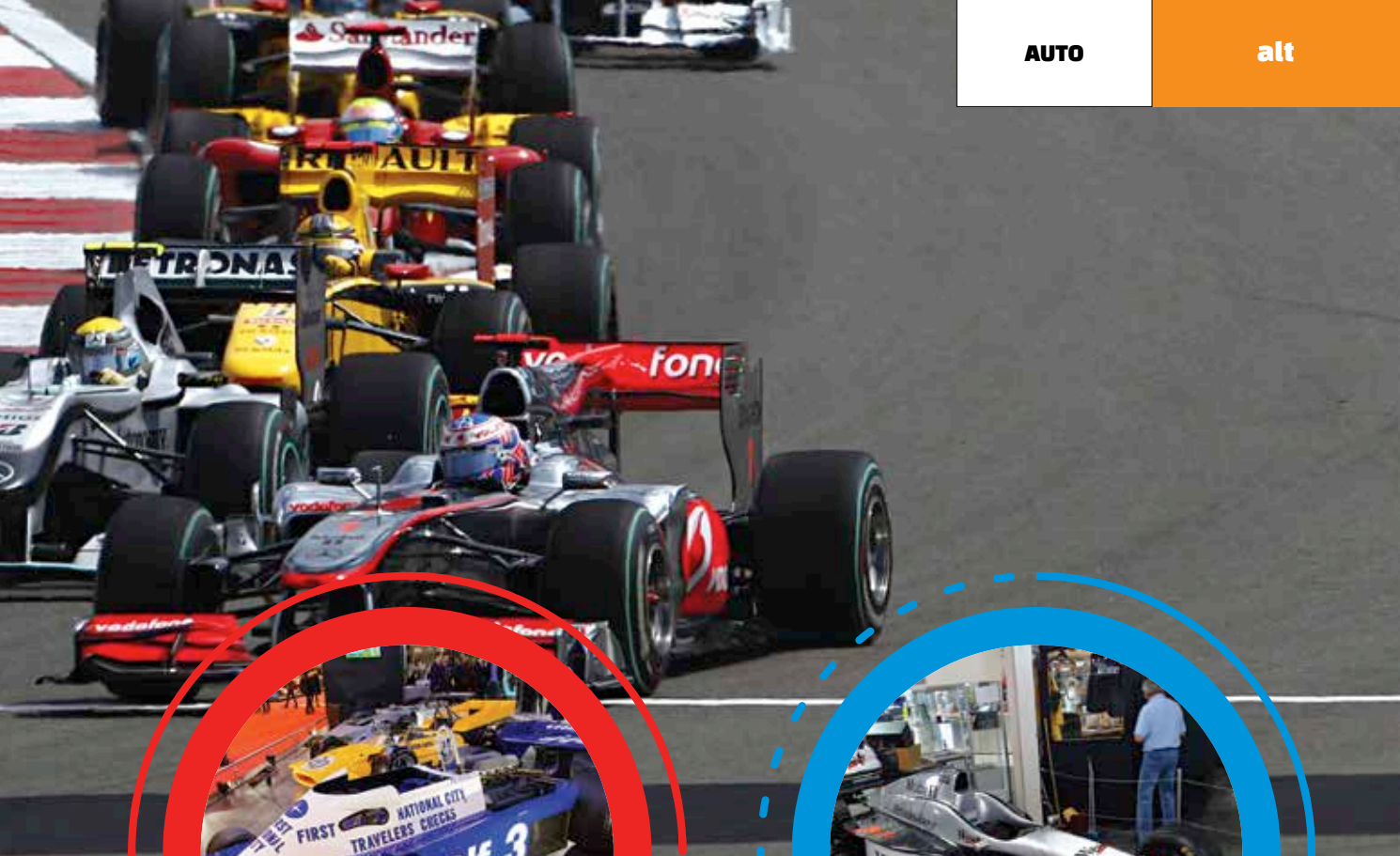




7

THE SIX-WHEELED MONSTROSITY

In all the years of you following F1, we are sure that no sight would be as strange as a six-wheeled car racing around the track. As absurd as it may sound, Formula 1, during the 1976 season, saw Tyrrell take their 6-wheeled F1 car, called the P-34, to the track. To the surprise of many who witnessed the car racing during that year's Swedish Grand Prix. Driven by Jody Scheckter, the car sped through the field to take the chequered flag before anyone else on the grid. However, that was the only taste of success that the car and team got that year. Come 1977, and due to the lack of even moderately impressive results, Tyrrell discontinued their 6-wheeled car. However, the concept was floated around for some time, as March, Ferrari, and Williams all played around with the idea until 1982! This concept however never made it to the tracks and with the current gen cars practically being rocketships on wheels, we might not see that design coming back soon.



8

REAR BRAKE PEDAL

One of the least surprising of all in this list of technical innovations that did not land well in Formula 1 is the rear brake pedal that was fielded by McLaren and two other teams during the 1997 season. Behind the wheel of the front-running McLaren that year was Mika Häkkinen, whose car was photographed by a cheeky journalist after his retirement from a Grand Prix, revealing the presence of a third pedal in the car. This additional brake pedal allowed the driver to independently control the rear braking of the car, not only providing extra control around the corners but also improving the overall drivability of the car. McLaren's innovation was protested by many teams. However, after Ferrari's massive protests against the change, the FIA banned it in the early parts of the 1998 World Championship season. In modern F1 cars, there is no need for the deployment of such a design as all the controls are present within a thumb's reach of a driver.